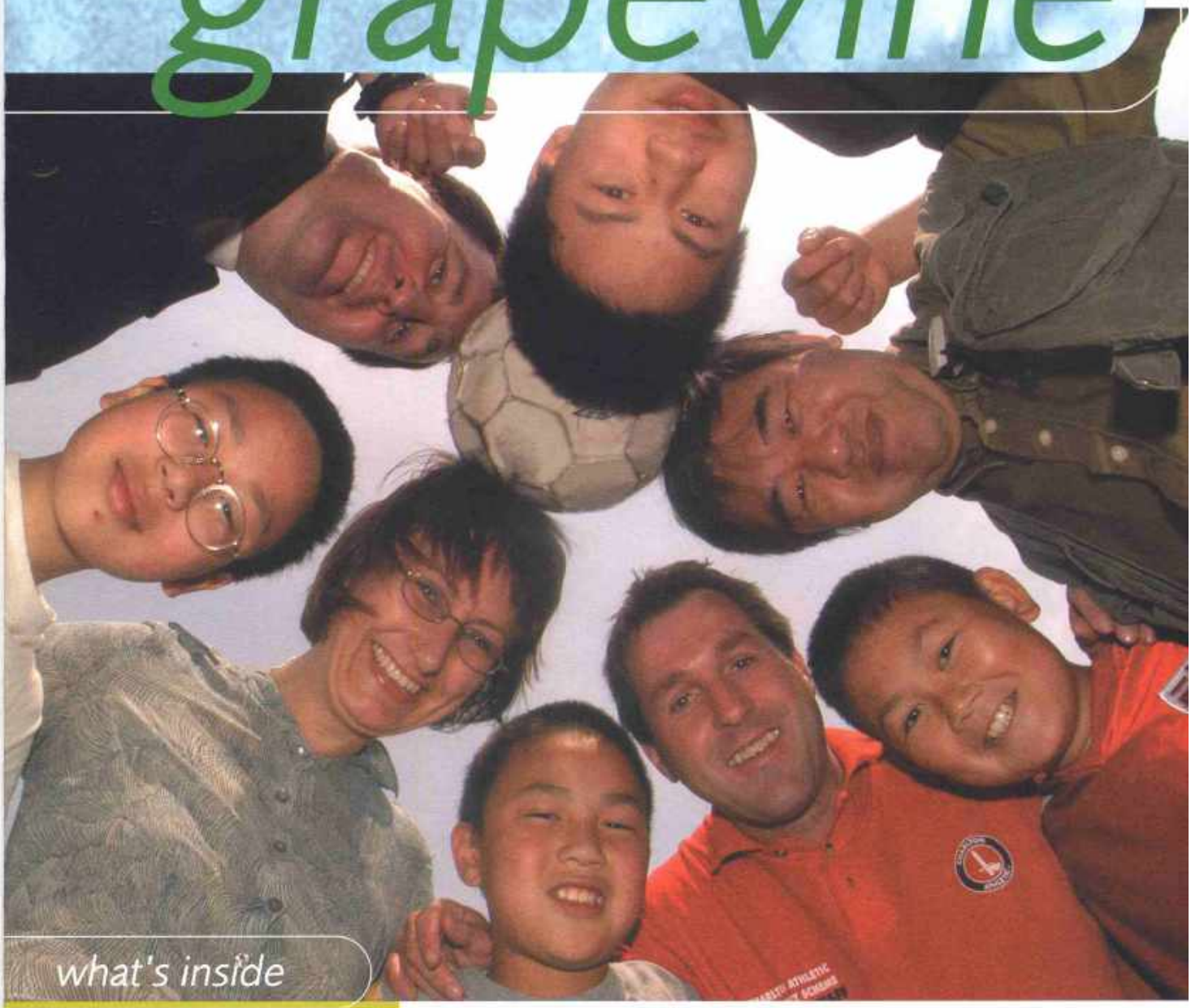
GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION

ISSUE 12

GALLIONS grapevine

July 2003



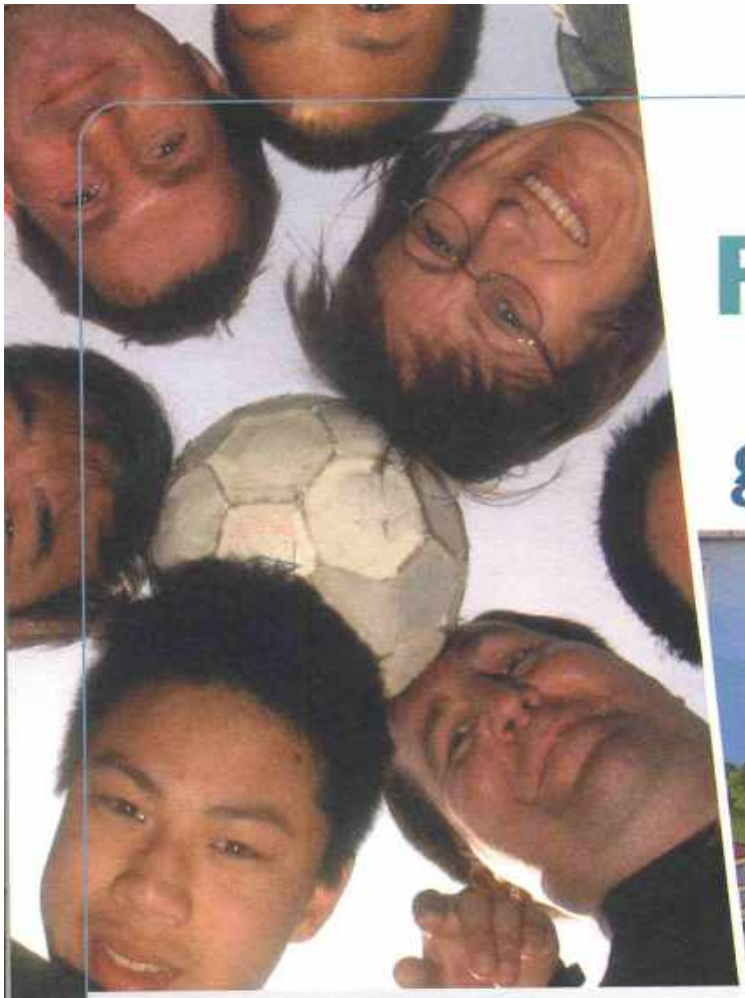
what's inside

Tenant resource centre facelift
Tavy Bridge update
Special constables
Southmere Lake cleans up
Thames Gateway news
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Housing Association news

Premiership football training for local children

32 children from the Chinese and Vietnamese community in Thamesmead benefited from football training provided by Charlton Athletic Football Club in March this year.

See **back page** for your list of contacts



Tenants Resource Centre gets new facelift





Local artist "Aztec" has completed a Thamesmead mural on the outside of the Tenant Resource Centre to mark the launch of the new facilities available at the centre.

The TRC now has the following new features and include:

- Redecoration of interior
- Modern crèche area for hire during meetings
- 7 computer workstations
- Binder/Laminator
- Photocopier
- Kitchen
- Disabled toilets
- Additional meeting rooms:
  Jubilee room for 16 people
  Thames room for 13 people
  Southmere room for 4 people

GRB members are delighted with the changes to the centre and hope that residents enjoy the new facilities.



The football sessions were so successful that Gallions, in partnership with Axis Europe plc, were delighted to fund a further 10 sessions which will run until the end of July. The children really enjoyed their early Saturday morning training which took place at Southlake Primary school.



The Tavy Bridge of the Future

The Tavy Bridge project office is now open for business.

Llewelyn Davies have put together an exciting exhibition featuring several design options for the upcoming redevelopment of Tavy Bridge. The exhibition will give you a feel of what Tavy Bridge could look like in the future and a chance to talk with the team and discuss which options you like best. It is an ideal opportunity to influence the decisions that will be made at Tavy Bridge.

The new project office is based in the old bank building in the row of shops on Tavy Bridge. Our opening hours are 10am to 4pm every weekday except Wednesday, when we are open from 1pm to 8pm. We are also open every other Saturday from 10am to 1pm from 21st June.

The project office is staffed by the new project team, which consists of Debbie Withall (Project Co-ordinator), Linda Harris (Resident Liaison Officer) and Sam Weaver (Project Officer). They will keep you up to date with what is happening at Tavy Bridge and are also very happy to provide more information. To share your views or to get involved, contact the team on 020 8320 8770.

We need YOU!

Do you have the right community values to make a personal difference as a volunteer Special Constable for the Thamesmead area.

We are looking for local residents to serve the local community as Special Constables. As a Special you will be properly briefed, supervised and tasked and your role will be to support the local crime reduction strategy.

Perhaps you've thought about a future career in the police and this would be an opportunity to get a feel for the kind of work involved.

Local courses will start later in the year. For further information please contact:

John Salisbury Jones 020 8284 9616

Inspector Andy Nimmons 020 8 284 9113

Kaye Sene 020 8320 3462



Good neighbours

We would like to congratulate all the winners of the Greenwich good neighbour awards, as part sponsor Gallions attended a presentation to the prizewinners in June.



Team Gallions
ENVIRONMENTAL SERVICES



Southmere Lake clean up





Team Gallions recently enlisted the help of pupils from St. John Fisher and Southlake School to help keep Southmere Lake tidy.

The big clean up session took place on the 6th of June with children helping members of Team Gallions pull reeds and rubbish from the lake.

As well as getting stuck into the rubbish, which included chairs, cushions, cans and cones on the day, the children were able to learn a little about the wildlife of the lake and how dumped rubbish can affect it. The children also got a chance to see a water vole, now an endangered species, inhabitating the waterways.

The tidy up forms part of Team Gallions ongoing drive to keep the canals and waterways of Thamesmead free of litter now that the Government funded Environment Agency has withdrawn its help.

"All in all it was a brilliant day and the children were really enthusiastic as they all got stuck into cleaning up the rubbish," said Kaye Sene, the Community Renewal Coordinator at Gallions. "At the end of the day the children were thrilled by how much they had learned about the environment."

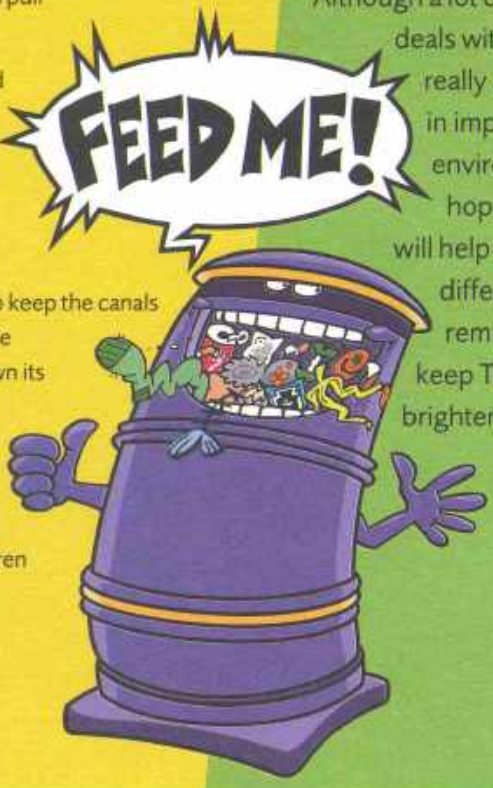
Roundabout Replanting

After the spring success of the tulips and wallflowers on the Yarnton Way roundabout, and the many appreciative comments we received, Team Gallions have replanted this roundabout for the summer. A show of colourful begonias, geraniums, busy lizzies and foliage plants now makes the area even brighter.

Bin there, done that !

Over the next few weeks you will begin to notice some new purple coloured bins around the area. As you may have noticed, we like purple at Team Gallions.

Although a lot of what we do deals with rubbish, we really are interested in improving the environment. We hope the new bins will help make a difference and remind everyone to keep Thamesmead brighter and cleaner!



Thames Gateway
Vision to Reality

On the 3rd June, Gallions part hosted a conference based on the Government's new action plan for sustainable communities in the Thames Gateway. This action plan wants to tackle housing problems across England and help create successful and thriving communities.

The conference was a great success with over 220 delegates attending. It allowed Gallions an opportunity to showcase Thamesmead as a major part of the Thames Gateway. Thamesmead has an important role to play in the future of the Gateway.

Shared ownership scheme

Gallions is delighted to introduce one of its first new Shared Ownership Schemes in Thamesmead.

What is shared ownership?

Shared ownership is a scheme which has been specifically designed to help those who are unable to afford the cost of buying a property outright on the open market. It works by enabling you to purchase an equity share in your new home, normally from 50% and pay a subsidised rent on the part you don't own to Gallions Housing Association. You will buy your home on a lease which will normally be 125 years for new homes.



FELIXSTOWE ROAD, ABBEY WOOD, SE2

For sale on a Shared Ownership basis from just £64,000*
16 x two bedroom apartments adjacent to Abbey Wood station

Features include:

- Carpets in the living/dining room, hallway and bedrooms
- Oven/hob/extractor
- Fitted kitchen
- Central heating
- Shower
- Door entry system to block

Just £250 can secure the home of your choice on the day.

For further information please contact our Marketing Team at Gallions on 020 8320 3460 or email homes@gallionsha.co.uk

*£64,000 represents a 40% equity share on an apartment with a full market value of £160,000. A monthly rent of £243.71 is payable on the share not owned and a monthly service charge is also payable.

Your home may be at risk if you do not keep up repayments on your mortgage, rent or any other loan secured on it.

Board information

Board meeting held on the 12th June 2003 at Gallions' Housing Association

Board appointments – new members
Mr Peter Dean from Blackheath and Peter Challis nominated by Greenwich Council will formally join the Board of Gallions at the AGM in September.

Governing Rules
Following the reconvened Special General Meeting on 23 April the revised Rules were unanimously agreed. The new Rules have also been approved by the Housing Corporation and Financial Services Authority and are now in place.

Annual General Meeting
The AGM for Gallions will be held on Wednesday 24th September at the Thistle Hotel, Brands Hatch. Those wishing to attend should contact Averyl Richards at Gallions on 020 8320 3410.

Housing Fayre

This year's Housing Fayre will be held on the 30th August with a celebrating diversity theme. There will be a range of foods from different cultures available as well as information stands and entertainment for children. As last year was such a success the venue will again be the parking area of Gallions' offices.

Feedback

We welcome your suggestions and comments on how we can improve our services and make your environment and home a better place to live in. Simply send your comments to:-
Feedback, Gallions Grapevine, Caroline Wilson, Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH.

Don't forget to add your name, address and telephone number for contact details or alternatively email me on cwilson@gallionsha.co.uk

ਜੇ ਅੰਗਰੇਜ਼ੀ ਤੁਹਾਡੀ ਪਹਿਲੀ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਨਹੀਂ, ਅਤੇ ਤੁਸੀਂ ਇਸ ਦਸਤਾਵੇਜ਼ ਦਾ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਚਾਹੁੰਦੇ ਹੋ, ਤਾ ਕਿਰਪਾ ਕਰਕੇ ਆਪਣੀ ਚੁਣੀ ਹੋਈ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਦੇ ਨਾਂ ਦੇ ਨੇੜੇ ਵਾਲੇ ਖ਼ਾਨੇ ਵਿਚ ਸਹੀ ਦਾ ਨਿਸ਼ਾਨ ਲਾ ਕੇ, ਅਤੇ ਦੱਸੀ ਹੋਈ ਥਾ 'ਤੇ ਆਪਣਾ ਨਾਂ ਅਤੇ ਪਤਾ ਲਿਖ ਕੇ ਇਹ ਫ਼ਾਰਮ ਕਿਸੇ ਲਿਫ਼ਾਫ਼ੇ ਵਿਚ ਪਾ ਕੇ ਹੇਠ ਲਿਖੇ ਪਤੇ 'ਤੇ ਭੇਜ ਦਿਓ।

如果英語不是您的母語，您希望將該文件翻譯出來的話，請在您選擇的語言旁邊打勾。請在所示之處填上您的姓名和地址，併用信封將本表格寄到下列地址。

Nếu Anh ngữ không phải là ngôn ngữ chính, Quý vị muốn dịch tài liệu này, xin vui lòng đánh dấu vào ô kế bên ngôn ngữ Quý vị chọn, ghi tên và địa chỉ vào nơi chỉ dẫn và gởi mẫu vào phòng bì theo địa chỉ dưới đây.

PUNJABI ☐ **CHINESE** ☐ **VIETNAMESE** ☐ *(please tick one)*

Name: .....

Address: .....

.....

Return to: Caroline Wilson (Translation Requests), Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH

Bexley Community Support service

ARP
Bexley Community Support Service

Are you falling behind with your rent because of alcohol or drug use?

If the answer is Yes – we may be able to help.

The Bexley Community Support Service is a specialist outreach team offering advice, information and support for people experiencing difficulties because of their alcohol or drug use. The service is free and confidential and available to any tenants over 18.

Do you find it a struggle to pay the rent? Have your benefits been stopped? Are you experiencing problems with your tenancy? Then maybe we can help. Our team consists of experienced outreach workers who can offer a full assessment, housing advice, welfare benefits advice and links into other services.

- Comprehensive needs assessment
- Referral into appropriate treatment
- Links into other services
- One to one with names keyworker
- Welfare benefits advice
- Budgeting and debt management
- Assisting in re-training and employment

Being referred to the service is easy. We can accept a referral by telephone or alternatively you could ask your housing manager or other professional to give us a call.

For further details please call 020 8312 3343 or pick up a leaflet in Gallions offices.

Contact us

Gallions Housing Association
Harrow Manor Way
London SE2 9XH
Customer Response Centre
Freephone
0800 83 84 81

This freephone number is now taking all calls to Gallions via the Customer Response Centre, this also includes switchboard calls.

The old switchboard number will be withdrawn in the coming months.